

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Radhika Joshi

Address: 64 Chiltern Road Sutton SM2 5RD

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I wish to formally object to the proposed change of use of the former ambulance station on Dorset Road, Belmont, from Sui Generis to mixed use Classes F1 (Place of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub).

Highway Safety and Traffic Impact

The surrounding road network is already operating under severe pressure, particularly during school drop-off and pick-up times. As a parent of a child attending a nearby school, I experience daily congestion which results in stationary traffic, unsafe vehicle manoeuvres, and increased risk to pedestrians, including children.

The proposal is likely to generate additional vehicular movements, including peak-time arrivals and departures that would directly coincide with school hours. This would materially worsen existing conditions and is contrary to the principle of promoting safe and efficient movement on the highway network.

In its current form, the proposal fails to demonstrate that the local highway network can safely accommodate the increased traffic demand without harm to road safety.

Parking Stress and Non-Compliance

On-street parking in the area is already heavily oversubscribed. This has resulted in enforcement action, including the issuing of parking tickets to residents and parents. I have personally received a parking ticket despite having no reasonable alternative available at the time (PCN SU75290967)

The introduction of a place of worship and community hub will significantly increase parking demand. The application does not provide sufficient evidence that this demand can be met within the site or without unacceptable overspill into surrounding residential streets.

This level of parking stress is harmful to residential amenity and is inconsistent with good planning practice.

Impact on Residential Amenity and Mental Wellbeing

The existing levels of congestion and parking pressure already place considerable strain on local residents and families. Daily exposure to gridlocked traffic, parking uncertainty, and enforcement risk causes ongoing anxiety and mental stress, particularly when trying to safely drop off or collect children from school.

An intensification of use at this site would further erode residential amenity by increasing noise, congestion, frustration, and unpredictability. The cumulative impact of these pressures has a tangible negative effect on mental wellbeing, family routines, and quality of life for nearby residents.

Planning policy places importance on creating safe, healthy, and sustainable communities. A development that exacerbates stress, reduces safety, and undermines day-to-day living conditions runs counter to these objectives.

Conclusion

For the reasons outlined above, the proposed development would result in unacceptable harm to highway safety, parking conditions, residential amenity, and the mental wellbeing of local residents. The application does not demonstrate that these impacts can be adequately mitigated.

I therefore respectfully request that this application be refused, or at the very least deferred pending a comprehensive and credible transport, parking, and mitigation strategy.